

PONTIFICIA UNIVERSIDAD JAVERIANA · SCHOOL OF ECONOMICS & ADMINISTRATIVE SCIENCES

MARKET RESEARCH PROJECT

AXE

Unilever's Deodorant Brand in the Colombian Personal Care Market

MARKET RESEARCH COURSE

TEAM

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What This Report Covers

01

Introduction

Why market research matters, and the scope of this study

02

Documentary Research

Category trends and Axe's performance, via Euromonitor Passport

03

Qualitative Research

Social listening and brand perception, via NVivo

04

Observational Research

In-store checks across three Colombian retailers

05

Conclusion

The research problem and a related initiative for the brand

06

References

Sources consulted throughout the study

Why We Studied Axe

Before making business, operational, or commercial decisions, companies turn to market research to collect and analyze the data that inform them. This report gathers that kind of intelligence for Axe, Unilever's deodorant brand, in the Colombian market — drawing on statistical databases, user opinions, and the brand's physical presence on store shelves.

1

Documentary

Category-level statistics from Euromonitor Passport, tracking sales and share over time.

2

Qualitative

Social listening across Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram, analyzed in NVivo.

3

Observational

First-hand store checks across three retail formats in Colombia.

01

SECONDARY DOCUMENTARY RESEARCH

Sizing Up the Category

What Euromonitor Passport's statistical data tells us about Axe and the Beauty & Personal Care category in Colombia.

Study Design & the Brand

STUDY: ISA — INDUSTRY SECTOR ANALYSIS

TECHNIQUE

Statistical information

DESIGN

Quantitative, secondary, analytical, longitudinal

DATA COLLECTION

Euromonitor Passport platform

ANALYSIS TOOL

Excel

ABOUT AXE IN COLOMBIA

Launched globally by Unilever in France in 1983 and reaching Colombia in 1985, Axe has grown steadily by adapting to new product development around health, wellness, hygiene, and appearance. In Colombia, the brand leans into a natural-beauty positioning — herbal, mineral, fruit-extract, and organic formulations.

According to Passport, the brand has built progressive success in the Colombian market since its launch.

Category Trends Shaping the Market

1

Clean formulations

Ingredients like parabens, sulfates, and silicone are increasingly frowned upon; consumers now favor "clean" products across Mass and Premium segments.

2

Sun & blue-light protection

Rising awareness of UV damage and screen-emitted blue light is pushing brands toward protective facial formulations, priced to stay accessible.

3

Value-driven purchasing

Shoppers favor affordable, on-promotion, high-quality products, forcing competitors to innovate constantly and hold the line on unit prices.

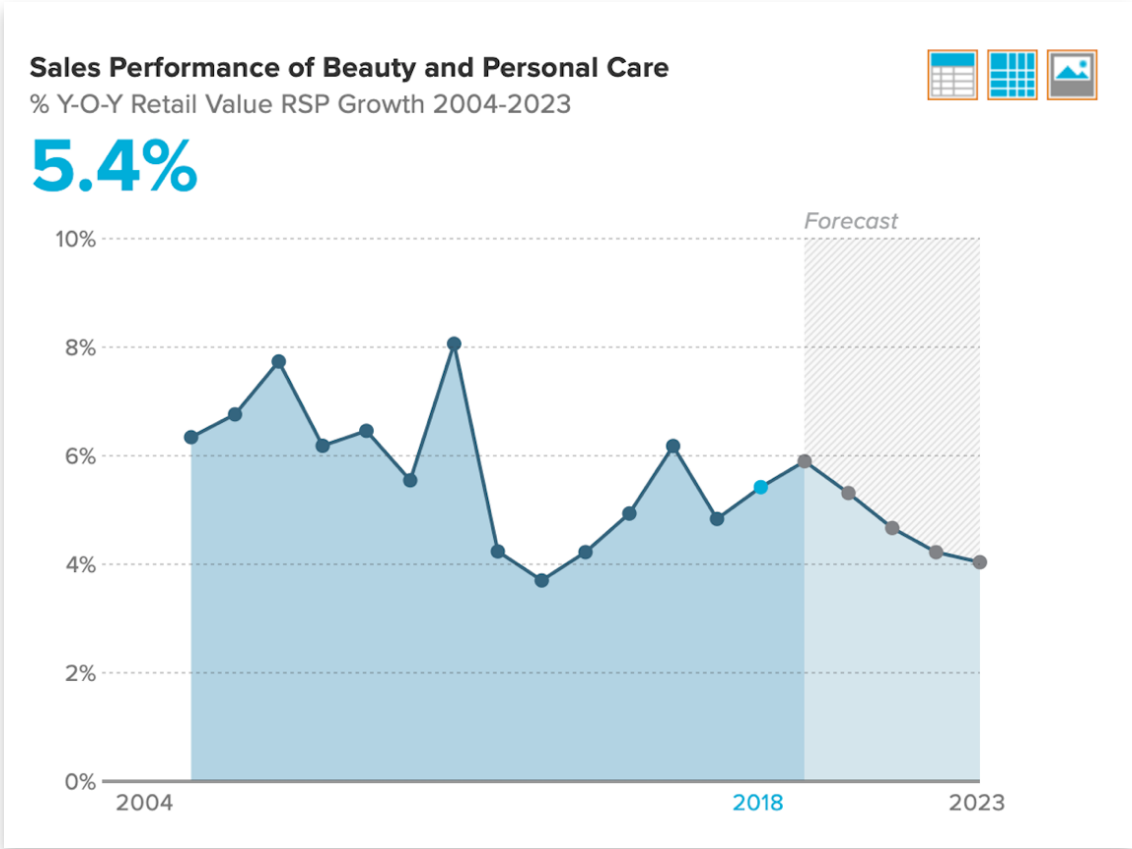
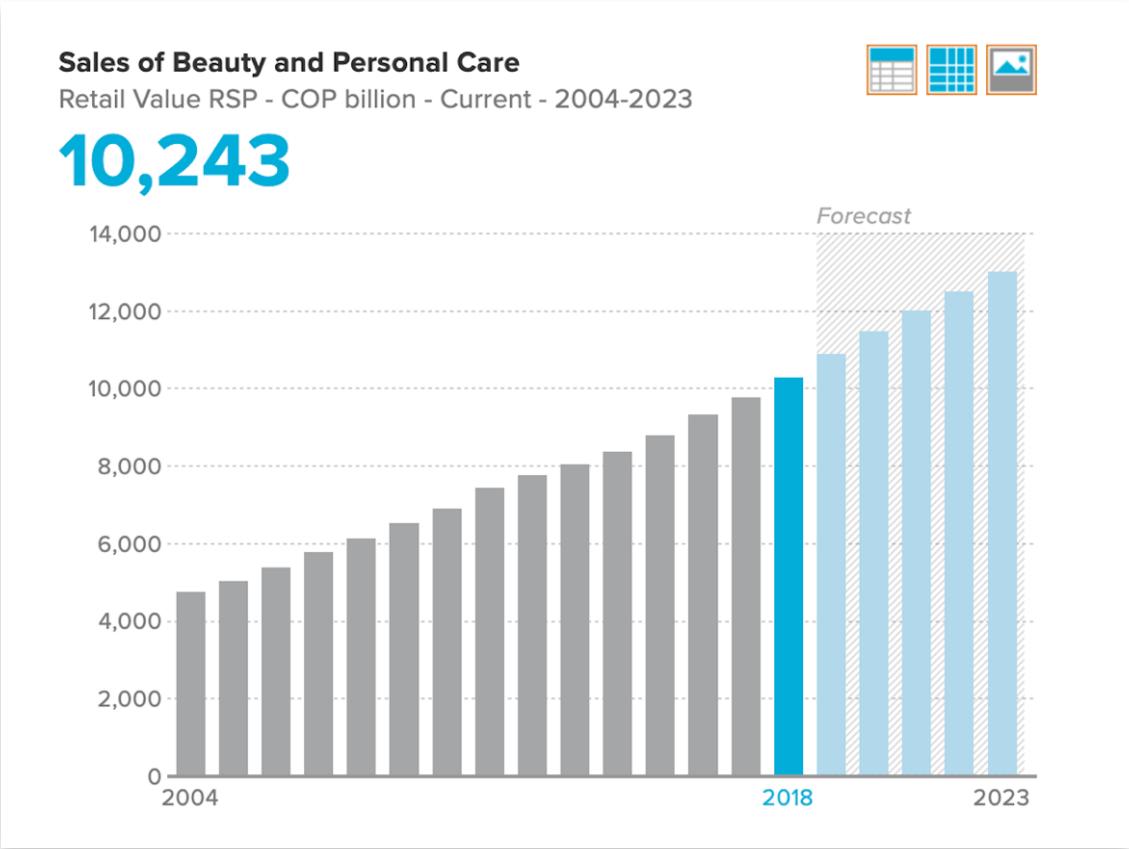
4

Private-label pressure

Retailers keep launching their own personal-care lines, adding to the competitive challenge that manufacturers like Axe already face.

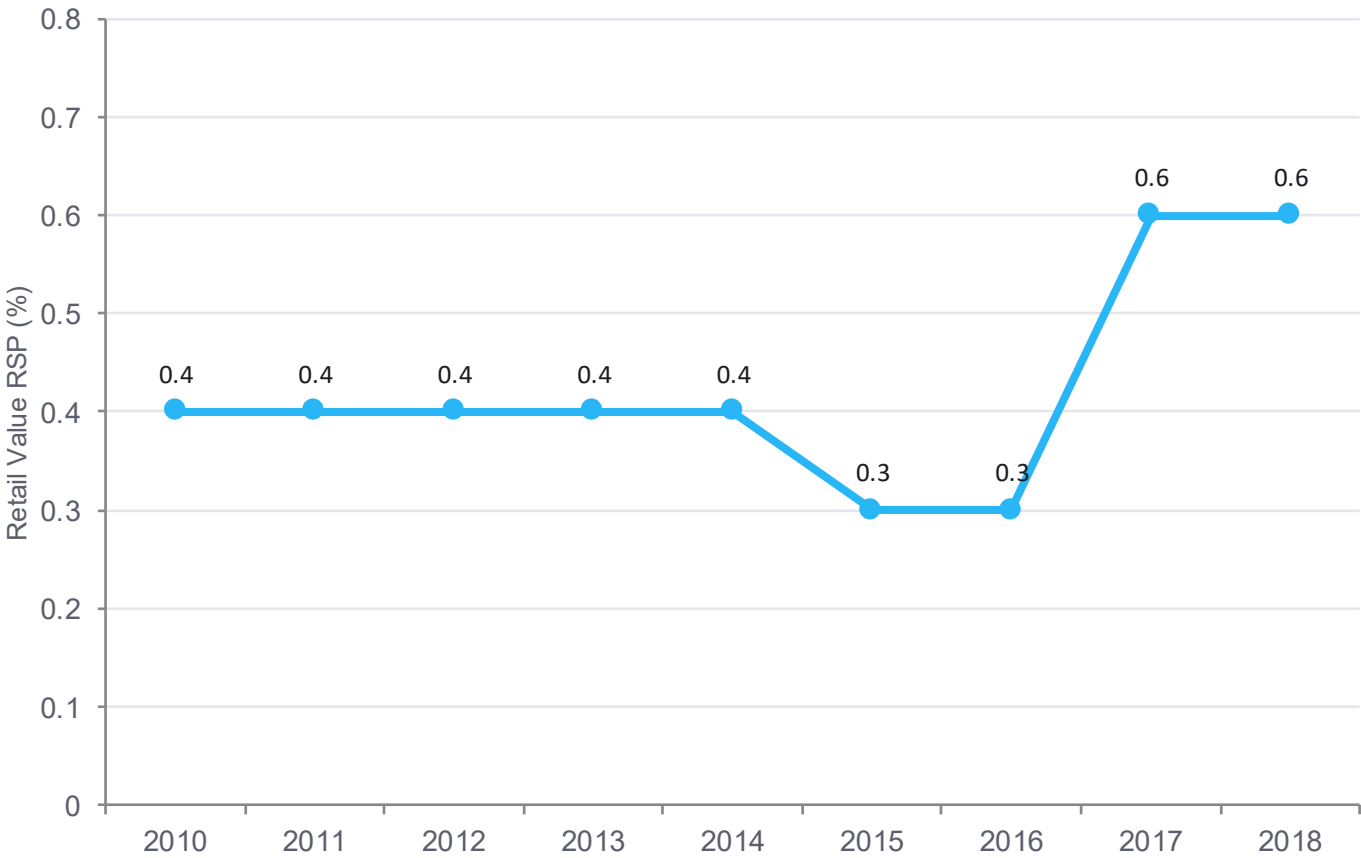
Category Growth in Colombia

Beauty & Personal Care sales have grown every year since 2004 — but only in small increments, shaped by a challenging economic environment. 2018 brought a stronger year than 2017, even amid a broader economic slowdown.



Source: Euromonitor Passport, Beauty and Personal Care, Colombia (2019)

Axe's Share of the Category



0.4% → 0.6%

Retail value share, 2010 → 2018

Axe held a flat 0.4% of Beauty & Personal Care retail value for most of the decade, dipped slightly in 2015–2016, then jumped to 0.6% in 2017 and held it through 2018 — the clearest share gain in the period.

Source: Euromonitor Passport — Brand Shares, Umbrella (Historical Owner), Colombia

02

SECONDARY QUALITATIVE RESEARCH

Listening to the Conversation

What NVivo's analysis of Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram reveals about how people talk about Axe.

Study Design

STUDY

Semantic Brand Perception

TECHNIQUE

Key Drivers

DESIGN

Qualitative, secondary, analytical, cross-sectional

DATA COLLECTION

Social media — Facebook, Twitter, Instagram

ANALYSIS TOOL

NVivo

What Social Listening Reveals



NVivo word-frequency cloud from Axe mentions across social media

KEY THEMES

"Opinión," "publicidad," "experiencia," and "desodorante" dominate the conversation — people are talking about the product and its advertising, not just the brand name.

A text-search query on "desodorante" surfaced a recurring critique: people want ads that show the product itself, not a woman used to sell it — a theme echoed across several comments.

Engagement is thin: few users actively rate or review Axe's products online, and a same-named capoeira academy clutters Facebook search results for the brand.

Voice of the Consumer

“

"The chill is amazing! Where can I buy the deodorant?"

@dfm84 · Instagram

“

"I always end up smelling delicious... oh wait, that's just my Axe Dark Temptation 48H Fresh."

@Orlandotrinos · Twitter

“

"If they want to sell a man a car, a beer, or cigarettes, they use a woman in the ad. If they want to sell ME a deodorant — just show me the deodorant!"

Miguel Caballero Montañez · YouTube



AXE MUSIC × MARTIN GARRIX

A limited-edition body spray built around DJ Martin Garrix drew warm reactions on YouTube ("the music video is awesome") — social listening's clearest example of a campaign landing well with the audience.

03

PRIMARY OBSERVATIONAL RESEARCH

On the Shelf

A first-hand look at where and how Axe shows up in three Colombian stores.

Study Design

STUDY

Check Store

TECHNIQUE

Observation

DESIGN

Qualitative, primary, analytical, cross-sectional

DATA COLLECTION

Store visits and field records

ANALYSIS TOOL

None specific — direct observation

Across every store sampled, Axe shared shelf space in the Personal Care / Men's Grooming section with Rexona and Speed Stick as its closest neighbors.

Store-by-Store Comparison

	Drogas La Rebaja	Carulla Supermarket	Farma-Unión (Nueva Arlequín)
Format	Small neighborhood pharmacy — no aisles, glass counter display	Large supermarket — Men's Personal Care aisle	Small neighborhood pharmacy — single open gondola
Shelf position	Bottom of the counter, left corner	Top of the gondola, easy to reach but low-contrast packaging	Top of the gondola, right corner
Nearby brands	Rexona, Dove, Savital	Speed Stick, Gillette, Old Spice	Nivea Men, Speed Stick, Dove
Price range (COP)	\$15,800 – \$18,000	\$16,400 – \$23,950 (2-packs)	\$13,500 – \$14,500 (lowest observed)

None of the three stores separate men's and women's deodorants — Axe sits directly alongside women's lines in every format.

Photo Evidence from the Shelf



Drogas La Rebaja: Axe on the middle shelf of the glass counter, between Rexona, Dove, and Gillette.



Carulla Supermarket: Axe Black, Gold Temptation, Ice Chill –6°C, Excite, and Dark Temptation, priced \$14,350–\$23,950.

CONCLUSION

The Research Problem & a Related Initiative

This study set out to understand Axe's positioning in Colombia's Hygiene & Personal Care segment, and how its market participation has moved over recent years. Consumer sentiment tracks closely with how people perceive the brand's advertising across social media — and Axe's strong international footprint means it reaches a wide range of consumer profiles, raising the stakes for every campaign it runs.

Share is moving up

Retail value share rose from 0.4% to 0.6% in 2017–2018 — the initiative should protect and build on that gain.

Advertising is under scrutiny

Recurring criticism of women-as-selling-tool imagery suggests real upside in product-first, less gendered creative.

Shelf presence is passive

Dark, generic packaging and no gender segmentation make Axe harder to spot — in-store visibility is a lever worth pulling.

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